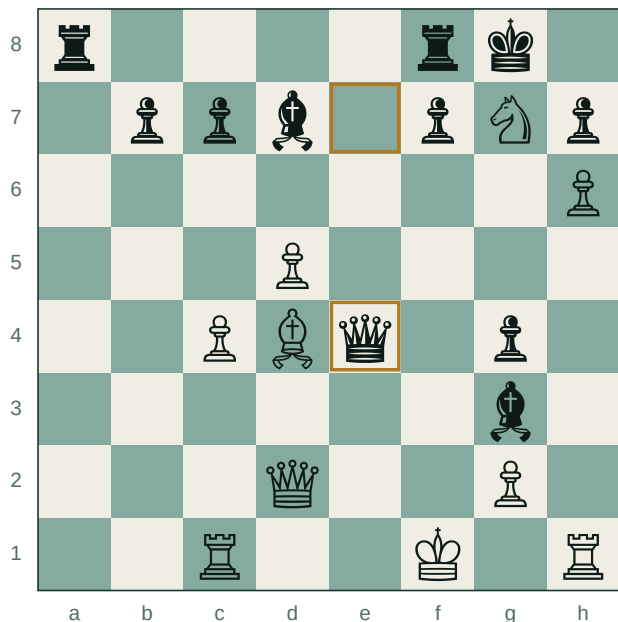


Deflection tactics: White, move 29

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 28...Qxe4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

29. Nh5 Be5 30. Qg5+ Qg6 31. Qxe5

29.Nh5 The knight moves from g7 to h5. Recorded reply: **29...Be5**.

30.Qg5+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. From g5 it attacks king on g8 and bishop on e5. Recorded reply: **30...Qg6**.

31.Qxe5 The queen captures the bishop on e5.

At the end, nominal material is White 29 / Black 27 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: bishop on d7 and queen on e4. Check for tactical protection.